Effective Curriculum Adaptation for SEND Children and Young People:

A Training for Teachers and Teacher Support Assistants

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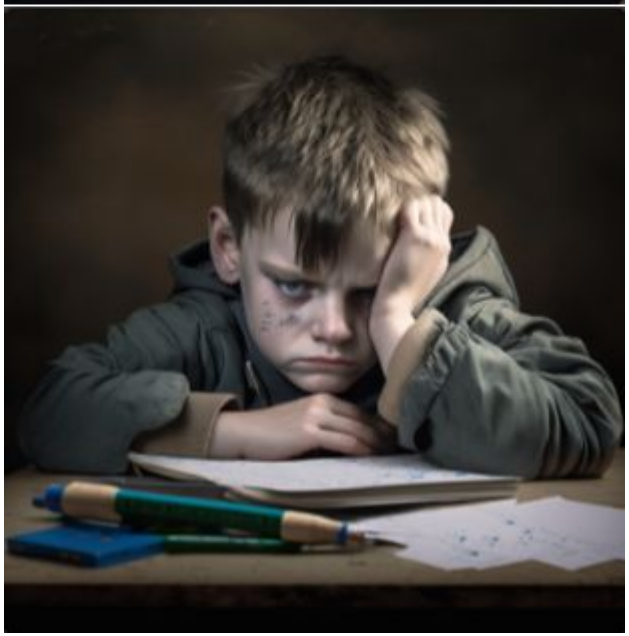
Training Goal

- The goal of this training is to provide practical strategies that will enable teachers and teacher support assistants to plan and implement successful adaptations that meet the diverse needs of SEND students.



Training Objective

- By the end of the training, you will have an improved understanding of effective curriculum adaptation for SEND children and young people and practical strategies for adapting the curriculum.

Training Aims

- Assessing the current level of knowledge and skills of the teachers and teacher support assistants [5min group task]
- Defining curriculum adaptation and its importance
- High-quality teaching strategies for curriculum adaptation
- Practical examples of successful adaptations
- Tips to help teachers remember the difference between curriculum adaptation and differentiation and apply it when designing lesson plans
- Forward planning, ongoing assessment, and feedback

Group Tasks

Activity 1

In your packs you will find paperclipped scenarios normally faced by teachers when planning curriculum content.

Sort each (paperclipped) scenario under the header of either …

adaption or differentiation

Activity 2

Take a look in the white envelope. You will find adapted lesson plans from teachers whose pupils have Autism, ADHD,EF challenges, Dyslexia and dyscalculia.

Sort each teachers plan into either …

adaptation or differentiation

Defining Curriculum Adaptation

- Curriculum adaptation involves modifying or changing the curriculum to meet the needs of learners with disabilities or other learning needs.
- Effective curriculum adaptation is important because it can help ensure that all pupils have the opportunity to learn and succeed, regardless of their abilities or needs.

Comparison of curriculum adaptation and differentiation

Curriculum adaptation differs from differentiation, which involves modifying teaching methods or strategies to meet the needs of different learners.

While differentiation may involve adapting teaching strategies for groups of students, curriculum adaptation involves modifying the curriculum itself to better meet the needs of individual learners.

Challenges that teachers may face when implementing effective adaptations:

- Teachers may face a range of challenges when implementing effective adaptations, including lack of time, resources, and training. They may also face challenges in identifying and addressing the specific needs of individual learners and ensuring that adaptations are appropriate and effective.

High-Quality Teaching Strategies for Curriculum Adaptation

Effective teaching strategies for curriculum adaptation can include modifications to content, instruction, or assessment.

Examples of modifications to content may include simplifying text, using real-life examples, or providing additional background information.

Modifications to instruction may involve adapting the pace, structure, or format of lessons to better meet the needs of learners.

Modifications to assessment may involve using alternative assessment methods, such as project-based assessments or oral assessments.

High-Quality Teaching Strategies for Curriculum Adaptation

- Catering to different learning styles and abilities: It's important to cater to different learning styles and abilities when planning curriculum adaptations.
- For example, visual aids such as diagrams, charts, or videos may be effective for learners who are visual learners, while hands-on activities may be effective for learners who are kinaesthetic learners.
- Adaptations should also consider the strengths and weaknesses of individual learners and provide opportunities for them to develop their skills and abilities.

High-Quality Teaching Strategies for Curriculum Adaptation

- Visual aids to illustrate the teaching strategies: Visual aids such as infographics or diagrams can be useful for illustrating the different teaching strategies for curriculum adaptation.
- Using visual aids can also make the strategies more accessible and engaging for learners.

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Practical Examples of Successful Adaptations

Practical examples of successful adaptations can include personalised learning plans, sensory activities, or the use of technology.

These adaptations are designed to meet the specific needs of individual learners and may involve modifications to content, instruction, or assessment.

Adaptations should be evidence-based and shown to be effective in supporting learners with disabilities or other learning needs.

Demonstrating Practical Examples of Successful Adaptations

Teachers should strive to demonstrate examples of successful adaptations in action, through videos or images of actual classroom adaptations.

This will help to provide a clear understanding of how adaptations can be implemented in practice.

Teachers and teacher support assistants to share their own examples of successful adaptations.

Sharing experiences and best practices can help build a supportive community of educators who are committed to providing the best possible learning experience for their pupils.

Additional examples of curriculum adaptation

1. Simplifying complex math problems for pupils with learning disabilities.
2. Modifying a reading assignment to be shorter and more manageable for pupils with attention issues.
3. Adjusting the level of difficulty for an art project to accommodate pupils with fine motor skill challenges.
4. Providing alternative assessment options for pupils with language barriers, such as allowing them to use visual aids or technology to demonstrate their understanding.
5. Modifying the seating arrangement or classroom environment to minimise distractions for pupils with sensory processing challenges.
6. Adapting a history lesson to be more culturally responsive and inclusive of all pupils' backgrounds and experiences.
7. Providing additional time and support for pupils who struggle with executive functioning skills, such as organising their materials or managing their time effectively.

Additional examples of curriculum differentiation

1. Offering advanced reading materials or extension activities for pupils who need a greater challenge.
2. Providing individualised coaching and feedback for pupils who need additional support to master a specific skill or concept.
3. Allowing pupils to choose from a variety of presentation formats (e.g., written, oral, visual) to demonstrate their understanding.
4. Offering opportunities for self-directed learning or inquiry-based projects for pupils who are highly motivated or independent.
5. Providing differentiated instruction in small groups or one-on-one settings to meet individual pupils needs.
6. Adjusting the pacing of instruction or providing additional breaks for pupils who struggle with attention or hyperactivity.
7. Offering opportunities for choice and autonomy in learning, such as allowing pupils to select their own topics or activities within a given framework.

Steps for Curriculum Adaptation and Differentiation in Lesson Planning

Identify	Identify the diverse needs and abilities of all pupils in the class.
Determine	Determine whether a particular need requires a change in the curriculum itself (curriculum adaptation) or a change in how the instruction is delivered or supported (differentiation).
Adapt	Adapt the curriculum or instruction based on the identified needs and abilities.
Assess	Continuously assess pupil progress and adjust the curriculum or instruction as needed to meet individual pupil needs.

I.D.E.A. for Curriculum Adaptation and Differentiation

I - Identify pupil needs and abilities

D - Determine whether to adapt the curriculum or differentiate instruction

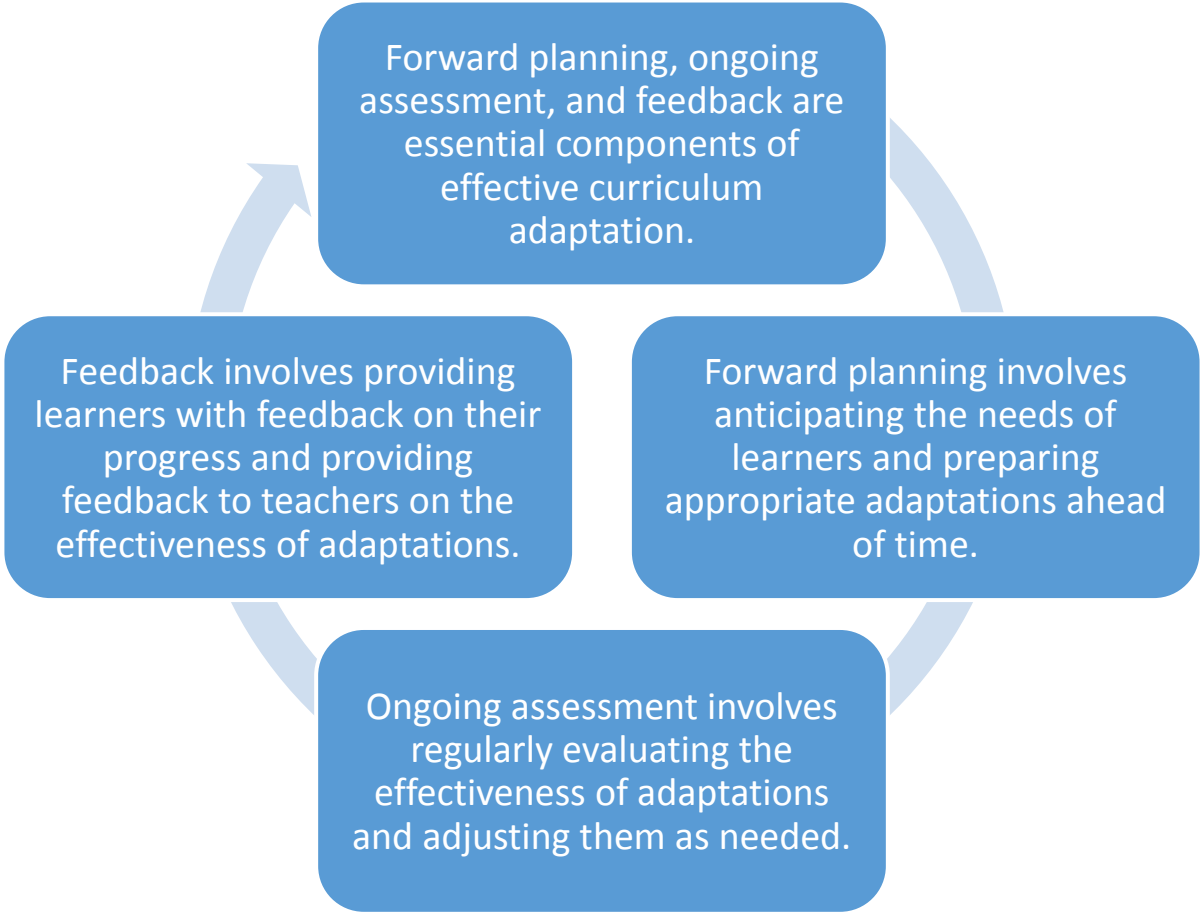
E - Adapt the curriculum or instruction

A - Assess progress and adjust as needed

Tips for Designing Effective Lesson Plans

Plan	Plan for both curriculum adaptation and differentiation from the beginning of the planning process.
Be	Be flexible and open to adjusting the curriculum and instruction based on pupil needs.
Use	Use a variety of instructional strategies and resources to meet diverse learning needs and styles.
Encourage	Encourage pupil input and involvement in the learning process to promote autonomy and engagement.
Collaborate	Collaborate with other teachers, specialists, and families to gather input and support for meeting individual pupil needs.

Forward Planning, Ongoing Assessment, and Feedback



Explanation of how to incorporate these into curriculum adaptation

Incorporating forward planning, ongoing assessment, and feedback into curriculum adaptation involves a cyclical process of planning, implementing, assessing, and adjusting adaptations.

Teachers should plan adaptations based on the needs of learners, implement them in the classroom, assess their effectiveness through ongoing assessment, and adjust them as needed based on feedback.

Tools and Techniques for Effective Planning, Assessment, and Feedback in Education

Tools or techniques that can support forward planning, ongoing assessment, and feedback include:

- Personalised learning plans
- Checklists for assessment
- Technology tools for assessment and feedback (e.g. educational apps, online quizzes)
- Collaborative planning and assessment with other teachers and teacher support assistants

Recap of the key points covered in the training

Throughout the training, we have covered the definition and importance of curriculum adaptation, high-quality teaching strategies, practical examples of successful adaptations, forward planning, ongoing assessment and feedback, and establishing a learning community

We have provided strategies, examples, and resources to support effective curriculum adaptation for SEND pupils

Encouragement to put the training into practice

Teachers and teacher support assistants are encouraged to put the training into practice and to use the strategies and resources provided to support effective curriculum adaptation

It is through practice and feedback that we can continue to improve and build on our skills and knowledge

Thank you for attending this training and for your commitment to providing effective curriculum adaptation for SEND pupils.

I appreciate your dedication to improving the learning and development outcomes of all pupils.

If you have any questions or feedback, please feel free to contact me through your SENCo, preferably via the termly virtual consultation sessions.

Exclusive Access to Doctoral Thesis

Request a Copy of My Doctoral Thesis Before Publication

As a thank you for your participation in today's training, I am offering delegates the opportunity to request a PDF copy of my doctoral thesis before its official publication.

The thesis is titled:

'What Can Children and Young People Tell Us About School Sanctions and Social Relationships: *An Exploration of Exclusionary and Restorative Justice Practices'*

If you are interested, please feel free to contact me at s.ighavongbe-patrick@buckinghamshire.com.